Was the political leadership of independent India not able to analyse the realities as we did above and conclude that agriculture should have been the moving force of the economy in place of industry? Is it possible that Pandit Nehru in command could have missed the rational analysis of the Indian realities, a giant among the Asian visionaries of the time (Mao was still to emerge on the international scene)? How India could have not opted for agriculture as its prime moving force whose leadership had fought the nationalist movement on the Gandhian fervour of villages, agriculture and rural development. Even if Gandhi was not in the Government there were many devout Gandhians in it and no one should doubt that the main internal force which vibrated throughout the governmental decisions were nothing but 'Gandhian Socialism'. There were many decisions which were taken under the influence of the main political force of the times, still some very vital ones were influenced by the visionary hunches of the political leadership mainly being J.L. Nehru. This is why the economic thinking of independent India is considered and said to be nurtured by the Nehruvian Economics still today. If we go through the major literatures on the Indian economic history, views of the critiques of the time and the contemporary experts, we may be able to feel the answer as to why India went for industry as its prime moving force in place of an obvious and logical choice of agriculture (we should not be happy to know that even today this is a highly debatable issue among experts):

(i) Looking at the resources available, agriculture would have been the obvious choice as the prime moving force (PMF) of the economy (i.e. cultivable land and the manpower). But as Indian agriculture was using the traditional tools and technology its modernisation as well as future mechanisation (latter to some extent) would have been blocked due to the lack of indigenous industrial support. If we had gone for import this would have required enough foreign reserves and a natural dependence on foreign countries. By choosing industry as the PMF we were going to industrialise the economy as well as modernise our traditional mode of farming.

(ii) The dominant ideology around the world as well as in the WB and the IMF was in favour of industrialisation as a means to faster growth which could be translated into faster development. These